Paulo Chaves da Silva Filho

Senior Software Engineer

opchaves.com Github LinkedIn

paulo@opchaves.com Teresina-PI, Brasil

Summary

I'm a Senior Software Engineer with a decade of experience building systems that scale and solutions that last. Currently, I'm at Thunkable helping to bridge the gap between human ideas and mobile apps by using LLMs to enable natural language creation. I'm a firm believer in the power of AI-augmented engineering, not just in the products I build, but in how I build them. Whether I'm working in Node.js, React, or Ruby on Rails, my focus is always on combining deep technical craftsmanship with the latest in AI, like Claude Code and Gemini, to solve meaningful problems at scale.

Skills

- **AI & LLM:** Claude Code, Gemini CLI, Anthropic API, OpenAI APIs, Prompt Engineering, AI-Augmented Development
- **Backend:** Node.js, TypeScript, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, REST, GraphQL
- **Frontend:** React.js, React Router, Next.js, Vite, Redux, Tailwind CSS, TypeScript, UI/UX
- **Infrastructure & Ops:** Docker, Kubernetes, GCP, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Git
- **Testing:** Playwright, Cypress, Jest, Vitest, Truffle

Experience

Senior Software Engineer at Thunkable

April 2023 to Current

- Architect and develop AI-driven application generation features using LLMs (Claude, Gemini) via APIs, transitioning the platform from Blockly/drag-and-drop to a natural language interface.
- Develop and maintain scalable Node.js backends with REST and GraphQL APIs, integrating data sources like Google Sheets, Airtable, and Baserow to power dynamic web, iOS, and Android applications.
- Build and optimize infrastructure using Docker and Kubernetes to enable seamless app generation across platforms (React Native, Expo).
- Lead end-to-end feature development, managing database, backend, frontend (React.js, TypeScript), and mobile components.
- Migrate extensive JavaScript codebases to TypeScript, enhancing maintainability and type safety.

- Optimize backend processes and MongoDB performance to improve operational efficiency and scalability.
- Implement end-to-end tests with Playwright, ensuring robust feature validation and application reliability.
- **Technologies:** Node.js, TypeScript, React.js, GraphQL, LLMs (Claude, ChatGPT), Docker, Kubernetes, MongoDB, Redis

Software Engineer at BairesDev

July 2020 to December 2022

Consulting for North American tech companies.

Blazer (formerly Brooks Bell) — Frontend Developer (Experimentation)

- Architected and injected 100+ high-traffic A/B tests using Vanilla JavaScript and jQuery via Adobe Target, enabling rapid experimentation without direct source code access.
- Engineered complex UI/UX overrides on live production sites, utilizing advanced DOM manipulation to re-structure page layouts and functional components.
- Eliminated "content flicker" and layout shifts by optimizing script execution and leveraging Adobe Target's custom code editor for sub-second delivery.

Instructure — Software Engineer

- Enhanced core Canvas LMS components (e.g., Gradebook) using Ruby on Rails, React, and TypeScript.
- Developed RESTful APIs and complex data models in production with Rails, utilizing ActiveRecord and background job processing.
- Contributed to feature development from start to finish, clarifying requirements, scoping solutions, and collaborating across disciplines to implement changes.
- Built accessible (WCAG) and internationalized (i18n) web experiences for a global audience of millions of users.
- **Technologies:** Ruby on Rails, React.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, AWS, Docker.

Senior Fullstack Developer (Remote) at Movinga

August 2019 to March 2020

- Work across the stack to develop scalable, performant and well-tested applications.
- Work on designing, building and maintaining efficient, reusable, and reliable code.
- Work on building UIs with Next.js and React.js.
- Work on migrating company's website to a headless CMS + Gatsby (JAM stack).
- Work on practicing and contributing to engineering best practices.
- Work on communicating and coordinating with fellow engineers, product owners, and users.
- Work on integrating Salesforce (API, views, reports) with Movinga services.
- **Technologies:** Node.js, React.js, Gatsby, Rails, Postgres, Redis.

Blockchain Engineer (Remote) at Lucidity Tech

February 2018 to April 2019

- Work with Ethereum, Dapps, Smart Contracts, and Solidity.
- Develop an event processing pipeline that handles thousands of tracking events per second, stores them, transforms them, and forwards them to third party analytics services.
- Integrate large and complex data sets from multiple sources into a single unified system through APIs.
- Development of APIs using Node.js and Ruby.
- Write automated tests for Smart Contracts using Truffle and Vitest.
- Frontend development with React.js.
- **Technologies:** Node.js, Ruby, Ethereum, Solidity, React.js, Truffle, Vitest.

Software Engineer at Codeminer42

January 2018 to April 2019

- Build and maintain high-quality software for international customers and internal tools using JavaScript and Ruby.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams to deliver scalable solutions following engineering best practices.
- Acted as a consultant for Lucidity Tech, specializing in blockchain and full-stack development.
- **Technologies:** JavaScript, Ruby, Ruby on Rails, REST APIs.

Software Developer at SEFAZ-PI

September 2016 to April 2017

- Developed high-performance batch jobs for the Department of Taxation and Finance.
- Built Python scripts to parse tens of millions of CSV files stored as CLOBs in Oracle databases into JSON format.
- Configured and managed a three-node MongoDB replica set (primary, secondary, and arbiter) for data persistence.
- **Technologies:** Python, Oracle, MongoDB, Shell Scripting.

Full-Stack Developer at Tartigrado Tecnologia

January 2016 to June 2016

- Developed a web application for a non-profit organization using Java and modern frameworks.
- Integrated Spring Framework into a legacy Struts2 application and implemented Spring Data to enhance database access and maintainability.
- Built new features using AngularJS for the frontend, communicating with the Struts2 backend via REST APIs.
- **Technologies:** Java, Struts2, Spring, Hibernate, jQuery, Angular.js, Foundation.

Full-Stack Developer at Supra Tecnologia

January 2010 to December 2012

- Developed a web application for the public health system, improving appointment and exam scheduling for over a million people.
- Responsible for the adoption and implementation of Git version control within the company.
- Led the refactoring of the system from MySQL with raw queries to PostgreSQL, introducing an ActiveRecord framework to abstract database access.
- **Technologies:** PHP, MySQL, PostgreSQL, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Git.

Education

- Computer Science, Loyola University Chicago – 2014 - 2015
- Systems Analysis and Development, Federal Institute of Technology in Piaui – 2013 - 2019